22.4.2 Causes for Endangerment

There are various reasons why a species may become endangered or extinct. Some of them are explained below.

a. Loss of habitat

Trees that provide food and shelter to so many species are destroyed due to human intervention.

b. Over hunting and poaching

Large number of animals are hunted for their horns, skin, teeth and many other valuable products.

c. Pollution

Number of animals are affected by pollutions like air pollution and water pollution. In the recent years more number of animals is affected by wastes in the form of plastic.

d. New habitat

Sometimes animals are taken by people to new habitat where they do not naturally live. Some of them may extinct and some may survive. The new ones may also get attacked by the species already living there and cause their extinction.

e. Chemicals

We use pesticides and other chemicals to get rid of damaging insects, pests or weeds. But they can also poison desired plants and animals if we do not use them correctly.

DO YOU KNOW?

At one time Dinosaur, ferns and some gymnosperms were wide spread on the earth. They disappeared from the earth, may be due to shortage of space and food or due to climatic change.



f. Diseases

Diseases due to various unknown reasons may affect the animals and make them extinct.

g. Natural calamities

Animals may also be destroyed due to natural disasters like flood and fire.

22.4.3 Saving Endangered Species

Nature is beautiful and it is filled with different plants and animals. For maintaining healthy ecological balance on the earth, animal and plant species are important. They have medicinal, scientific, ecological and commercial value. Each organism on the earth has a unique place in food chain that contributes to the ecosystem. But they are endangered mainly due to human activity. We need to take certain measures to protect them and preserve them.

- Some of the animal species are endangered mainly because of hunting and poaching. If it is controlled there can be a significant change in the number of endangered animals.
- Controlling pollution can have a positive impact on animals, fish and birds all over the world.
- When we consume more, more pollutants are put into the environment. By consuming less, we can protect the ecosystems.
- Animals often mistake plastic for food and hence plastics harm and cause endangerment of many species. Limiting the amount of plastic and recycling it can save the endangered animals.
- Recycling things and buying eco friendly products will preserve the environment resources and hence the animals.
- Pesticides and chemicals which cause damage to the environment should be avoided.
- Planting native trees will provide food to the animals.

DO YOU KNOW?

Planting the native trees like Neem tree, Umbrella tree and Banyan tree in our surrounding will be helpful for the animals. Many birds and animals find shelter in those trees.

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